

# **JSS 2 CULTURAL AND CREATIVE ARTS – FIRST TERM**

---

## **TOPIC 3: CRAFTS – MATERIALS, TOOLS AND EQUIPMENT**

### **1. Meaning of Crafts**

Crafts are handmade objects produced with skill, often for use or decoration. Examples include pottery, weaving, basketry, beadwork, leatherwork, wood carving, tie-and-dye and batik. Crafts combine practicality with artistic expression and cultural identity.

### **2. Materials**

Clay, wood, raffia, cotton and other fibres, beads, leather, dyes, paper, metal, calabash, and recycled materials. Choice of material depends on the type of craft and local availability.

### **3. Tools and Equipment**

Knives, scissors, needles, brushes, looms, pottery wheel, carving tools, dyeing pots, moulds, rulers and cutting mats. Tools should be used safely and kept clean and sharp.

### **4. Craft Locations in Nigeria**

Different regions are known for particular crafts: e.g. pottery in parts of the North and East, bronze casting (Benin), weaving (Akwete, Okene, Aso-Oke), leatherwork (Kano), wood carving (various areas), and beadwork. Local craft centres and markets support livelihoods and culture.

### **5. Summary**

Crafts use materials and tools to make useful and beautiful objects. Nigeria has rich craft traditions in many locations. Learning crafts develops skill, creativity and cultural pride.

End of Topic 3